

Instructions for Formatting Assignment

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Introduction

The following formatting guidelines are suggested for reporting the solutions to the assignments, i.e., exercises at the end of the chapters and the case studies. Those instructions are a good practice for the presentation of information in a professional setting.

All responses must be typed using either Microsoft Word or some other suitable word processing software. Convert the document including all text, tables, graphs, and other relevant information into a single (!) pdf-document. You have access to Adobe Acrobat through the university and there is no need to purchase the software yourself. Responses must be concise. In general, the pdf-file should have the following characteristics:

1. All pages should be in portrait mode and numbered.
2. The document should be single-spaced and use a font size of 12 points.
3. The font should be either Times New Roman or Arial.
4. A title page is not necessary but rather a short title on top of the first page, e.g., Homework 1. Include your name on the first page, the date of submission, and the assignment number.
5. Dollar values over \$100,000 should be rounded to the nearest integer. Anything below \$100,000 should be reported using two decimal places. For percentage changes, report one decimal place.

Tables and Graphs

Your tables and graphs should be self-explanatory. The reader should be able to read and fully understand what your graph is saying without reading the accompanying text. To achieve this effect, all graphs and tables should have the following information where appropriate:

- Brief and descriptive title
- Clearly labeled x -axis and y -axis with the y -axis starting at 0 if only positive or negative values are reported.
- A clearly defined legend and maybe notes, which explain less obvious aspects of the graph.
- An indication of the data source for the information portrayed in the graph.

Table

Table 1: Revenues and Outlays of the Federal Government.
Source: Office of Management and Budget.

Year	Outlays	Receipts
2010	5122.024	3204.275
2011	5230.373	3343.816
2012	5025.637	3491.433
2013	4841.203	3888.658
2014	4829.189	4161.486
2015	5037.847	4434.754
2016	5207.816	4417.509
2017	5287.635	4403.914
2018	5334.442	4323.017
2019	5679.552	4423.334
2020	8213.532	4311.897

Graph



Figure 1: Revenues and Outlays of the Federal Government. Source: Office of Management and Budget.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial intelligence (AI) tools may be used to assist with assignments. Examples include ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, or similar tools. However, you remain fully responsible for the accuracy, interpretation, calculations, data, citations, and conclusions contained in your submitted work. An AI-generated response should not be treated as an authoritative source. If AI is used, include a brief AI Appendix at the end of the assignment, after the references. The appendix should contain (1) the name of the AI tool, (2) the prompt(s) or script used to generate material that contributed meaningfully (!) to the assignment, and (3) a brief statement identifying how the AI output was used, such as assistance with calculations, computer code, data interpretation, editing, or development of an argument. Do not include pages of AI-generated output unless specifically requested. Only the prompts or script necessary to document your use of AI should be provided. Routine uses such as spelling, grammar, or minor formatting assistance do not need to be documented.

All numerical results, factual claims, references, and data obtained with the assistance of AI must be independently verified using appropriate sources. Fabricated references, incorrect calculations, or other errors produced by an AI system remain the responsibility of the student. When an assignment specifically requires AI use, additional instructions may ask you to evaluate, verify, or critique the AI-generated response. In such cases, the quality of the AI response itself is not the primary objective; your ability to assess and use it appropriately is. The AI response itself is not the answer to the exercise. Your grade is based on your ability to verify, evaluate, and improve upon the analysis.

Assumptions

While I strive to make the assignments as clear as possible, ambiguity may still arise. Except for glaring errors, you are expected to make assumptions as necessary to solve the assigned problems. These assumptions should be clearly stated as footnotes. Your results are only as credible as your assumptions; be ready to defend your assumptions.

References

Your work may be based on information you gather from multiple sources. It is important that you document these sources and give credit where appropriate. Your reference list should come at the end of your work. Do not place it in the middle or at the end of each question.